

School of Economic, Political and Policy Sciences

Sustainability Planning and Policy (BS)

Sustainability Planning and Policy explores the intricate relationships between ecological, economic, social, and political systems, as well as the behaviors and policies that influence these interactions. At its core, sustainability studies seek to understand human impact on the natural and human environments and promote responsible stewardship of natural resources. This field of study also encompasses economic development, social equity, governance institutions, education, public opinion, civil society, and ethical considerations related to social responsibility. Given its interdisciplinary nature, sustainability is a fundamental theme across multiple programs within the School of Economic, Political, and Policy Sciences (EPPS).

Mission Statement

The mission of the BS in Sustainability Planning and Policy program is to equip students with the knowledge, skills, and tools to address the complex environmental, social, and economic challenges of sustainable development. The program will prepare graduates to develop and implement innovative plans, policies, and solutions that promote sustainability using both theoretical principles and cutting-edge technologies. It fosters a commitment to resilience, social responsibility, and environmental stewardship within communities and organizations.

Students within the program will:

- Gain a deep understanding of concepts, theories, and principles for sustainable development
- Analyze human-environment interactions and their impacts on global and local environments
- Apply advanced technologies, methods, techniques, and planning practices to address sustainable challenges
- Evaluate environmental policies and regulations influencing sustainable developments

Bachelor of Sustainability Planning and Policy

[Degree Requirements](#) (120 semester credit hours)

[View an Example of Degree Requirements by Semester](#)

Faculty

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Professors: Yongwan Chun, Dohyeong Kim, Robert C. Lowry, Fang Qiu, May Yuan

Associate-Professors: Eugenia Gorina, James R. Harrington, Muhammad Rahman, Kevin Siqueira

Assistant-Professors: Elías Cisneros, Erin Litzow, Allison Russell

Clinical-Professor: John R. McCaskill

I. Core Curriculum Requirements: 42 semester credit hours

Curriculum Requirements can be fulfilled by other approved courses from institutions of higher education. The courses listed are recommended as the most efficient way to satisfy both Core Curriculum and Major Requirements at UT Dallas.

Communication: 6 semester credit hours

[EPPS 2307](#) Digital Earth¹

or [GISC 2307](#) Digital Earth¹

or [GEOS 2307](#) Digital Earth¹

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Communication Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Mathematics: 3 semester credit hours

[MATH 1325](#) Applied Calculus I^{1, 2}

or [MATH 2413](#) Differential Calculus^{1, 2}

or [MATH 2417](#) Calculus I^{1, 2}

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Mathematics Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Life and Physical Sciences: 6 semester credit hours

Select two courses from the following:

[GEOS 1303](#) Physical Geology

[GEOS 2304](#) Earth Energy Resources

[GEOS 2310](#) Environmental Geosciences

[ENVR 2302](#) The Global Environment

or [GEOG 2302](#) The Global Environment

or [GEOS 2302](#) The Global Environment

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Life and Physical Sciences Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Language, Philosophy and Culture: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Language, Philosophy and Culture Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Creative Arts: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Creative Arts Core](#) courses (see advisor)

American History: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [American History Core](#) courses (see advisor).

Government/Political Science: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Government/Political Science Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Social and Behavioral Sciences: 3 semester credit hours

[ECON 2301](#) Principles of Macroeconomics¹

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Social and Behavioral Sciences Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Component Area Option: 6 semester credit hours

[EPPS 2301](#) Research Design in the Social and Policy Sciences¹

[EPPS 2302](#) Methods of Quantitative Analysis in the Social and Policy Sciences¹

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Component Area Core](#) courses (see advisor)

II. Major Requirements: 64 semester credit hours

Major Preparatory Courses: 16-17 semester credit hours (1 semester credit hours beyond Core Curriculum)

[EPPS 1110](#) Critical Issues in the Social Sciences

[EPPS 2307](#) Digital Earth¹

or [GISC 2307](#) Digital Earth¹

or [GEOS 2307](#) Digital Earth¹

[MATH 1325](#) Applied Calculus I^{1, 2}

or [MATH 2413](#) Differential Calculus^{1, 2}

or [MATH 2417](#) Calculus I^{1, 2}

[ECON 2301](#) Principles of Macroeconomics¹

[EPPS 2301](#) Research Design in the Social and Policy Sciences¹

[EPPS 2302](#) Methods of Quantitative Analysis in the Social and Policy Sciences¹

Major Core Courses: 42 semester credit hours

[ECON 2302](#) Principles of Microeconomics

[ECON 3310](#) Intermediate Microeconomic Theory

[ECON 4324](#) Economics of Sustainability

or [IPEC 4324](#) Economics of Sustainability

or [PPOL 4324](#) Economics of Sustainability

or [PSCI 4324](#) Economics of Sustainability

[GEOG 3331](#) Smart and Sustainable Cities

or [EPPS 3331](#) Smart and Sustainable Cities

or [ENVR 3331](#) Smart and Sustainable Cities

[GEOG 3372](#) Population and Development

[GEOG 3377](#) Urban Planning and Policy

or [PA 3377](#) Urban Planning and Policy

[GISC 2309](#) Principles of Geospatial Information Sciences

[GISC 3336](#) Fundamentals of Sustainability

or [EPPS 3336](#) Fundamentals of Sustainability

or [ENVR 3336](#) Fundamentals of Sustainability

[GISC 4386](#) Climate Change and Sustainable Solutions

or [EPPS 4386](#) Climate Change and Sustainable Solutions

or [ENVR 4386](#) Climate Change and Sustainable Solutions

[GISC 4325](#) Introduction to Remote Sensing

or [GEOS 4325](#) Introduction to Remote Sensing

[IPEC 3349](#) World Resources and Development

[PA 3382](#) Sustainable Communities

or [SOC 3382](#) Sustainable Communities

[PPOL 4305](#) Policy Analysis, Theory, and Methods

[PSCI 4304](#) Energy and Environmental Politics and Policy

Sustainability Policy Electives: 21 semester credit hours

Select seven courses (21 semester credit hours) from the following:

[ECON 4333](#) Environmental Economics

[ECON 4336](#) Environmental Economic Theory and Policy

[EPPS 4300](#) EPPS Policy Lab

[GEOG 3357](#) Spatial Dimensions of Health and Disease

[GEOG 4338](#) Hazard and Disaster Management

or [EPPS 4338](#) Hazard and Disaster Management

or [ENVR 4338](#) Hazard and Disaster Management

[GISC 3342](#) Artificial Intelligence for Environmental Social Science

[GISC 4310](#) Environmental and Health Policy in East Asia

or [IPEC 4310](#) Environmental and Health Policy in East Asia

[GISC 4382](#) GIS Database and Modeling

[GISC 4384](#) Health and Environmental GIS

[IPEC 4396](#) Topics in International Political Economy (when the topic related to environmental

policy)

[PA 3333](#) Human Resources Management

[PA 4357](#) Measuring Social Impact

[PPOL 4302](#) Data and Policy

or [PSCI 4302](#) Data and Policy

[PPOL 4311](#) Wicked Social Problems

[PPOL 4398](#) Internship

[PPOL 4V91](#) Undergraduate Research in Public Policy

[PSCI 4396](#) Selected Topics in Government and Politics (when the topic related to environmental policy)

III. Elective Requirements: 14 semester credit hours

This requirement may be satisfied with lower- and upper-division courses from any field of study.

Incoming and transfer students may need to complete the necessary 1000-level mathematics course, i.e., [MATH 1314](#), prior to taking [MATH 1325](#) or [MATH 2312](#) prior to taking [MATH 2413](#).

The plan must include sufficient upper-division courses to total 45 upper-division semester credit hours.

1. A Major requirement that also fulfills a Core Curriculum requirement. Semester credit hours are counted in Core Curriculum.

2. Incoming and transfer students may need to complete the necessary 1000-level mathematics course, i.e., MATH 1314, prior to taking MATH 1325 or MATH 2312 prior to taking MATH 2413.

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